Just Vibin'

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/47853652.

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Explicit

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Catra is Bad at Feelings (She-Ra), Lesbian Disaster Adora (She-Ra), Lesbian Disaster Catra (She-Ra), Catgirl Catra (She-Ra), First Kiss, Adora Has Issues (She-Ra), Adora Has A Praise Kink (She-Ra), Vibrators, Bad Humor, Roommates, Mutual Pining, POV Catra (She-Ra), Porn With Plot, Masturbation Fixes All Your Problems, Oh Wait It Doesn't, Adora Is a Frustrated Mess, Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), they are both idiots, First Orgasm Question Mark, This One Got Away From Me At The End, They are disgustingly in love your honor

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by DandyVela

Summary

"What do you mean you've never done it before?"
Adora scrunches her nose. She is staring into her bottle of beer like her life depends on it. Condensation makes her fingers twitch, dripping down between them. Adora swipes at the droplets with her thumb.
"It can't really mean a lot of things, Catra," she says. Her tone is sharp around her words, her jaw set tight. "It means that I've never done it before."

aka local catgirl has been pining for her roommate for over a year. naturally, this escalates to her teaching said roommate how rubbing one out can help with work related stress. it is not that easy.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

“What do you mean you’ve never done it before?”

Adora scrunches her nose. She is staring into her bottle of beer like her life depends on it. Condensation makes her fingers twitch, dripping down between them. Adora swipes at the droplets with her thumb.

“It can’t really mean a lot of things, Catra,” she says. Her tone is sharp around her words, her jaw set tight. “It *means* that I’ve never done it before.”

Catra bites back her immediate reaction, which would just be a long string of *what* and *wait* and *fuck*.

Adora takes her silence the wrong way.

“I know it’s weird,” she says with a scoff, then chugs a couple of gulps from her beer.

She rubs her mouth with the back of her hand, still avoiding looking at Catra. She stares at the TV screen instead, as if the most interesting thing in the world was the terrifying CGI of Mega Python vs. Gatoroid, and not the fact that Adora Gray, this literal fucking amazon, has never masturbated in her whole 28 years of life.

“It’s not weird.”

“Yeah, right.”

“It’s not,” Catra perseveres, turning away from the TV and fully towards Adora. She pulls her tail up, curling it under her knee. “I’m not surprised because I think it’s weird. It’s okay if you’re not into it.” Catra pauses to swallow. Now that she brought up the single most awkward topic one could possibly discuss with their infuriatingly hot roommate, she knows she has to offer being vulnerable in return. “I guess I just… don’t think I would know what to ask for from a partner if I didn’t know exactly what makes me come.”

Adora whips her head around, finally looking at Catra. Her lips pop open; her eyes are so wide, Catra can see the full rings of her stormy blue irises. Her features are going through some kaleidoscope-esque shape-shifting, never dwelling on one emotion long enough for Catra to decipher it.

Then she tucks her chin down and clicks her jaw shut. Catra's gaze involuntarily seeks out the way Adora's teeth sink into her pale lower lip, biting and quickly releasing. Blood rushes back in, painting her lip peach again.

Catra can barely hear the fake screams over the drumming of her heart.

"I—," Adora starts weakly, taking a deep breath. "I've never…"

"Oh," Catra breathes. She keeps her voice so low, so quiet, that she is afraid Adora won't even hear her; but she is even more afraid of messing up whatever fragile clusterfuck she dragged them both into. "Never been with someone?"

"No, I— ugh." Adora's frustration is back, shooting through her like a firebolt. "I've had sex before, I just—" She knocks her bottle against the coffee table so hard the glass almost breaks. She hides her face behind her palms so her whiny voice is muffled when she confesses with one breath: "I've never had an orgasm, okay? Not with someone else, not alone. It just doesn't happen."

Catra swallows her surprise to not give Adora the wrong idea again. Her heart crawls so high up her throat, Catra can almost taste it.

This is not where she imagined the conversation to go. To be fair, she didn't even imagine it growing into a conversation. Her plan was simple.

Adora has been coming home with so much resentment and anger towards her job that stress has turned her into an absolute nightmare. She is always frustrated, has rage fits over the smallest things that don't go according to plan, drops shit, slams

shit, growls and grunts even more than Catra with her certified *and* diagnosed anger management issues.

Catra has seen her try and tackle it in ways Adora knows: she's been exercising even more than usual, tried going for walks, went to sleep earlier. Nothing seemed to help, and honestly, it was really fucking infuriating to be around her. Flames of Adora's anger fostered Catra's, so their shared apartment turned into a war zone of constant bickering and fighting.

The worst and most annoying part of it: Catra loves it. Sure, she is annoyed by default (that's just who she is), but it has become harder and harder to keep her stupid blooming feelings at bay. She is aware of how much of a lesbian cliché she is being, falling for the girl she has been living with for the past year; but it was almost inevitable, considering Adora's mind, heart, and what she dares to look like.

God created the perfect woman for Catra, decided to make her a lesbian, put her in the same crappy two-bedroom one bath apartment, and made the punchline of the joke that she is absolutely, undoubtedly, unalterably not into Catra at all.

So Catra threw her stupid broken heart into the trash (it never stopped thinking about Adora), and during their usual Friday night shitty movie marathon, suggested to Adora the only thing that always helps her ease frustration: rubbing one out.

Adora choked on her beer, flushed pretty pink from neck to ears, and confessed something Catra had never expected to hear from her. Trashed heart or not, it was still capable of skipping a beat at the thought that no one has ever been able to make Adora cum, which could somehow put Catra in the same category as the girls Adora had dated. Catra is not any worse than Adora's exes who couldn't – or didn't – touch her until she saw stars and her legs were shaking, which is honestly a sin in Catra's eyes. If she were ever given the chance to put her hands and mouth on Adora, there is no way she would be left unclaimed.

It’s wrong, of course. Catra knows this. Adora is not an *achievement*, nor someone to own, and it doesn’t matter if Catra and the other girls have some similarities – Adora was still interested in them at some point in her life, but never in Catra. She can't just assume that the girls didn’t appreciate or know Adora well enough because she is unreasonably jealous. It’s ugly; but that’s all Catra is.

Her jealousy is ugly, her anger is ugly, her possessiveness is ugly, her stubbornness is ugly, her meanness is ugly. Catra is rotten inside whether or not she wants to accept it, and Adora would be an even bigger idiot than she already is if she ever believed Catra was worth something.

Fuck, that was such a mean thing to say, too.

Catra is beyond redemption.

She takes a sip of her beer just to do something with herself. From the corner of her eye, she notices that Adora is not hiding from her anymore. She has dropped her hands into her lap, pulled that pretty lower lip that will be the death of Catra between her teeth, and is looking right at her with the sweetest puppy eyes known to woman.

Catra freezes with the mouth of the bottle barely touching her own. She cracks under the pressure of the silence she thinks she is supposed to break, and at the exact same second Adora goes “Can you say something?”, Catra says: “I have a bullet vibe.”

The shift in the air is palpable.

“What?!”

“It’s brand new,” Catra adds, placing her beer next to Adora’s on the table. She pauses the movie and leans onto her elbow on the couch, cool and unaffected, like she doesn’t have a care in the world. Her cheek is squished in her palm, her eyebrow cocked. “You could try it. Maybe it’ll help.”

“I’m not gonna—”

“Why not? It doesn’t bite. Your pussy will be fine. More than fine, hopefully.”

“Stop talking about this!”

“You told me to say something!”

Adora growls, slapping both of her palms to her face. As always, her anger calls for Catra’s; she feels it bubbling up her stomach.

Catra lifts her head, dropping her hand. She takes a deep breath through her nose, and tries again.

“Look. If you’re not into any of this, you can just say that. Obviously I’m not forcing you to try sex toys or to touch yourself if you’re not comfortable with that. You said you never masturbated, but maybe you did, just couldn’t come, and you do have sex, I just… I don’t know what to make of this, and I want to help. So help me help you. Okay?”

Adora meets her eyes. Her gaze is so warm, kind and stormy blue. She turns towards Catra and crosses her legs, leaning forward.

“You… want to help me?” She asks, barely moving her lips.

Catra fidgets under the attention, feeling skittish.

“Yeah? Why else would I be talking about this?”

Adora shrugs a little. “To mess with me.”

Wow. Catra feels a pang in her chest. She bares her teeth and scoffs: “Oh, so that’s how little you think of me.”

“No, no, I—” Adora’s chest heaves with a sigh. Her fucking puppy eyes are back, clinging to Catra’s while she tries to turn her head and escape them. She can’t. “I, uh… I don’t really… do that. What we talked about,” she adds when she catches Catra’s grimace. “I

tried it a couple of times when I was younger. It felt good, but nothing special. At first I thought I just stopped too early, but trying for a really long time didn't help either. I tried everything, but I never got close. Buying toys felt useless, too. After a while, I just became frustrated with the whole thing. I didn't want to accept that I was broken, but I had to. I moved on, and never tried it again."

Catra opens her mouth, but she doesn't get a chance to cut in. Adora goes on without taking a breath, speaking every word faster than the one before.

"I started dating, and it was great, because I wasn't really into the people who were asking me out, so when we had sex, I could just fuck them and not let them touch me. I didn't want to be touched anyway. Even when I was with girls I was attracted to, or thought that I loved, I just… I couldn't have them try and realize that there is something wrong with me. Some didn't mind. Some broke up with me for it." Adora gasps for air, her lungs finally winning over her mouth.

Catra calls her name as softly as she possibly can. Adora's gaze has been zigzagging all over the room while she talked, only now landing on Catra's face again. She is so ridiculously gorgeous even with her bad posture, messy ponytail and sweatpants with speckles of marinara sauce on them, and she is *so* fucking dumb.

"I told you," Adora says with an empty grin, and rubs her cheek with her wrist. "It's weird."

"And I told you" Catra pulls Adora's hand from her face before she could stop herself, "it's not."

Adora's palm is cold in hers, and twitches when Catra runs her thumb between two lines. They've hugged before, occasionally, but never held hands. Never touched like this; never let it linger. Unsure of where the line is, Catra opens her palm to let Adora draw back if she wants.

She doesn’t.

So Catra brings it between their bodies, and holds it tight.

“You’re not weird, or broken. There is nothing fucking wrong with you, okay?”

Adora breaks.

“Catra, I *can’t come*.”

“Not with that attitude you can’t.”

Adora’s laugh is breathy. She hangs her head, shaking it slightly.

“Hey,” Catra tries again. “There could be so many reasons why it didn’t happen for you. It could be physical. It could be mental. I'm no expert, but I do know two things: One, you are not broken, and don't need to be fixed. You just need help."

The corner of Adora's mouth curls up, just a little. "And two?"

Catra swallows, dropping her gaze to their entwined hands for a moment.

"The girls who broke up with you because you said no to something are fucking assholes, and I hope they live terrible lives." Adora laughs again, loud now and full of joy. It makes Catra even braver. "And the girls who were okay with something clearly bothering you, and never tried to talk to you about it or help you can fuck themselves, too. It's really not your fault that people didn't treat you how you deserved."

Adora cocks her jaw slightly to the side, blinking rapidly. Her laughter has died out, leaving her strangely shimmering eyes to hold Catra captive. She squeezes Catra's hand, gently stroking along her knuckles.

Catra shivers from head to toe.

"Okay," Adora sighs with a tiny nod.

"Okay?"

"Okay. I'll try."

Catra grins wickedly. "That's the spirit."

Her grin melts almost immediately, taken over by pure dread.

She is such a fucking idiot. What did she expect was going to happen? She knew what she started when she offered Adora her vibe – she knew that it would mean that she would see the toy in Adora's huge hands, she knew that Adora would then go into her own room, close the door, and try to masturbate just a handful of feet away from her. And Catra would be hyper aware of the fact that it is happening.

It is pure torture.

She tries to block the thoughts out, but her brain is not cooperating. Fantasies of Adora pour in through the cracks, and it doesn't help that it's almost like she can hear her over the sound of the TV; she had even turned the volume up out of respect.

Catra's eyes are staring at some cooking competition on the screen, but all they see is Adora with her sweatpants around her ankles, thick thighs spread, the toy shimmering between her slick lips. Catra's sensitive ears are twitching as they catch the muffled buzzing and the rustling of the covers. When she swears she hears her own name moaned like a plea, she knows she's just neck deep in her own sad, wet daydream.

Catra's growl erupts from deep inside her belly, eyes squeezing shut. She crosses her legs to clamp her thighs together, and sits on the tip of her tail to stop it from thrashing. Her heart is hammering, threatening to burst out of her ribcage.

She should go for a walk or something. It’s not that late. Even if it was, getting robbed at knifepoint sounds better than staying ten feet away from the girl she's desperately in love with while she touches herself in a way she'd never let Catra. Their bedrooms are right beside each other, beds separated by just a thin wall, so Catra can't even hide under her covers and wait for it to pass.

Without thinking about it for even a second longer, she hops to her feet and makes a beeline for her leather jacket. As soon as she grabs it, Adora's bedroom door slams open.

Catra drops her hand, springing back. Her tail poofs to twice its size, lashing behind her for a second until she sees Adora clinging to her door frame.

Her shoulders are hunched, her sweatpants slipping to sit low on her hips. Her ponytail is so messy that the hair tie is fighting for its life at the last inch. Her cleavage is fucking gorgeous in the tight grey tank top she is still wearing; her skin is shimmering, the soft cotton is dark and heavy with a layer of sweat.

Adora's wild eyes cling to Catra's. She looks even more frustrated than before. Catra’s stomach drops at the defeated sight, her tail slowly curling around her ankle.

"Useless," Adora spits, flinging her arm with the bullet vibe. "This isn’t working."

She storms into the bathroom, leaning on the sink. Catra follows, guilt coating her tongue like bile.

"How do you clean this thing again?" Adora asks, shaking the vibe with trembling fingers. "Warm water, soap, right? Wet cloth, dry cloth?"

"Adora, wait." Catra steps behind Adora and touches her elbow carefully. "Take a deep breath, okay?"

Adora hangs her head and breathes in. Her exhale sounds like a sob. "I can't do it," she says, sounding even weaker than before.

"I can't do it. Why can't I *fucking* do it?"

Her voice gains strength in the end. She slams her hand on the sink, which creaks under her strength. The bullet vibe rolls out of her other hand, swaying just by the edge.

Catra's chest hollows. Her whole body goes numb except for the aching of her heart as it breaks for Adora.

"I can help."

If it wasn't for Adora staring at her with wide eyes and her jaw on the floor, Catra wouldn't have realized that it was her talking. She couldn't be that lucky. Her chest is tight with panic; her ears fold to her head.

"What?" Adora's voice is just a whisper.

She doesn't believe her. Perfect. Now Catra can turn this into a joke, say she just wanted to lighten the mood. Easy escape.

"I can help. If you want." *Fuck*. Catra's throat is so dry she swallows against nothing.

"Help… with…"

"Yeah."

They stare at each other for a long time. Neither of them blinks.

Adora turns towards Catra, the small of her back pressed against the sink. Her hands grip the edges on each side of her waist, pushing her chest out.

Catra takes a step closer, her jaw raised high. They almost touch in the narrow space. Catra is cold and blazing hot at the same time, the air heavy and sweltering with her embarrassing desire, every fiber in her body screaming for Adora's touch.

She asks like it is a challenge: "Will you let me or not?"

Adora shakes her head, just slightly. Catra's eyes start to burn; the muscles tense in her legs to help her flee before she starts sobbing, but then Adora says, so quiet and genuine like she is making an oath: "Of course I will."

Catra grins around a hesitant chuckle, suddenly feeling lightheaded. Her joyful expression quickly melts, dissolving into something more devout and hopeful when Adora's face mirrors hers; her cheeks are bright and rosy, and Catra wants to bite into them. She tilts her head instinctively as she takes in Catra's heated gaze.

"Can I kiss you?" Catra asks.

Adora leans down and kisses her. She is a little too keen, mushing Catra's lips to her teeth, her nose to Adora's burning cheek so Catra can't breathe through it.

Adora draws back as quickly as she had leaned in. Catra expects to see her startled, or even scared by her own boldness, but she finds no signs of uncertainty or regret. Adora's lips are pressed together in a thin line, her brows furrowed above striking eyes.

Her face says, *your turn*.

So Catra moves. She slides her palms up Adora's chest, right below her collarbones, and rises to her tiptoes to press their lips together.

Their second kiss is way softer, but Catra can't hold back. Adora parts her lips for her at the tiniest pressure of Catra's tongue, kissing her back even deeper. Catra's hands are all over Adora's neck and head, messing up her hair even more until every strand is high with electricity.

Adora kisses her as if she'd want to eat her alive, and before Catra can make any kind of noise, she finds herself hauled up and plunked down on top of the washing machine. Catra locks her ankles behind Adora's ass, clinging to the neckline of her tank top

on her back. Her claws scratch down the exposed skin of Adora's spine, earning a needy sniffle.

Catra draws back with a pop, leaving a hand on the side of Adora's neck where she can feel her heartbeat under her palm.

"Your place or mine?"

Adora crinkles her nose as she grins. Catra can see her actually mulling it over in her mind.

"Can we… go to mine?" She asks hesitantly. Catra doesn't need an explanation, but Adora gives her one anyway. "I think I'd feel more comfortable on, uh, my own ground."

"Sure," Catra says, booping her nose to Adora's before kissing her briefly again. "Anything you want."

She slides off of the washing machine. Adora's arms wrap around her immediately, her lips seeking out Catra's. Catra is not complaining. This is all she's wanted ever since Adora appeared on her doorstep to move in. She's imagined this so many times that she is afraid she is trapped in a fantasy; she is still on the couch, and nothing is real but her heartache.

Adora's hand gently guides Catra's head to tilt even more to the side. Their lips fit so perfectly together that Catra wants to weep. When Catra breaks the kiss, it feels like she is tearing off a part of herself; but if she doesn't, she will stay in the tiny bathroom for all eternity, never separating her mouth from Adora's.

She is not confident enough in her own abilities to believe that would get the job done.

Adora's arms are still around her waist, and Catra clings to her curvy biceps like her life depends on it. She feels herself slowly floating towards losing her mind, so she needs to know before it is too late:

"Hey, so… are you sure about this?"

"Yes," Adora breathes without hesitation. Catra can see her swallow. "Are you?"

"I offered."

"I know, but… You can change your mind anytime."

I would never fucking say no to you, Catra thinks, her throat closing. What she says is: "I know. I'd tell you."

Adora's smile is blinding. She drops her hand to lace her fingers together with Catra's and guides her out of the bathroom.

Catra snatches the vibe from the edge of the sink and slips it into her pocket.

Catra has been in Adora's room before, but those visits were for entirely different purposes. She was called in when Adora couldn't decide what to wear for her best friend's posh-ass birthday party; she had Adora on the phone guide her through unlocking her laptop and sending her a file for work when she left her flashdrive home; and Adora had once let her in to check if she accidentally put Catra's shirt with her own laundry when Catra couldn't find it.

None of those instances left Catra's heart beating unevenly out of her chest; and they definitely didn't include Catra being invited to Adora's bed. Thank God they've been drinking a little, because there is no fucking way Catra would be able to do this completely sober.

She feels grateful for Adora pulling her inside. For a second Catra forgot that she is supposed to be leading, showing Adora what it means to be touched by someone who would die for you.

Ew , Catra grimaces as she hears herself. Who the fuck has she become?

Adora spins around in front of her bed, chewing on her lip. Her hold falters, fingers slipping away. She clears her throat to say something, then chokes on her own spit instead. It sends her into a coughing fit.

Catra has never been more in love in her entire life. When Adora calms down, Catra lays a hand on her navel to push her back, almost squeezing her eyes shut at the contact. Adora's abs are so deliciously defined, like she had been carved from marble, and Catra has spent enough time staring at them without ever thinking she'd get to touch them.

Adora plops down on the bed and leans back on her hands, knees spread and eyes round as she looks up at Catra. Her hair flows onto her shoulders, still messy and thin like golden yarn. Catra plucks the brave hair tie off, relieving it from its service.

Adora is staring at her like a golden retriever staring at a slice of bacon.

"What?" Catra asks, sliding a knee up the bed. Adora's hand is immediately behind the crease, trying to pull her closer by the back of her thigh. Catra leans forward, gently encouraging Adora to scoot backwards until she is sitting against the pillows.

"Nothing," Adora forces out. "Just… you're… wow."

"Yeah?" Catra crawls over her and kisses her, smudging their lips with her grin. "Keep those *wow*s for when I'm actually touching you."

"I don't think I'll survive that," Adora admits. Her tone is only slightly humorous, her eyes shifting from summer sky to stormy sea.

Catra raises her brows, laying her weight against Adora's warm body. Adora's abs feel thrilling against the softness of Catra's stomach. "Yeah, right."

“I mean it,” Adora says, already breathing a little heavily. She slips down willingly, letting Catra wrap every inch of her torso with her own as they lay down. Her hands are tentative as she digs the heels of her palms into the valley of Catra’s spine.

Catra hollows her back, hoping Adora would venture further. She doesn’t; she keeps it innocent, melting Catra from the small of her back to the curve of her ribs while Adora kisses her again.

Adora is so sweet on her tongue, the movement of her lips curious but tame. The way her nails bite deeply into Catra’s skin is the only thing that reveals how much she actually wants this; how much strength it might be taking to hold herself back.

Catra doesn’t mind. She wants to keep this slow – to ease Adora into being touched, and to make it as torturous for her as she possibly can. She wants Adora to feel comfortable but also go wild with desperate need, bewildered by how she was able to go so long without Catra’s mouth on her.

Catra’s hand finds its way back to Adora’s chiseled stomach, loving the way it ripples under her palm. Her fingers crumple the hem of Adora’s tank top, pulling it just a little higher.

Adora parts their kiss and grabs Catra’s wrist. “You first,” she breathes before Catra could apologize, eyes clinging pleadingly to hers. “Please?”

Catra surprises herself when she swallows, feeling a lump growing in her throat. She has never been the shy type; she likes revealing clothes, to turn heads, to feel desired when women do a double take and leave their gaze on her at the bar.

But that was all a show.

She sits up on Adora’s hips, feeling them twitch beneath her. It gives her the last drop of courage she desperately needed to grab her loose shirt and pull it quickly over her head. She hadn’t put on a bra after showering earlier in the afternoon, so she is already completely exposed to Adora’s ocean-deep eyes.

And oh, they are on her. Adora's chest collapses with a dreamy, disbelieving sigh, heavy gaze following the bounce of Catra's tits when she chucks her shirt somewhere to the floor. Adora straightens a bit, getting her face closer to Catra's chest and, for a heartbeat, Catra thinks that Adora is going to put her mouth on her. But all Adora does is grab her own tank top and tear it off. She is wearing a sports bra underneath, the thin cotton stretching on her chest, tight around her nipples.

Catra knew Adora was more heavy-chested than her; she is no stranger to wearing tight tops, or coming out of her room after working out in just a sweaty bra and booty shorts. Catra has already seen how the top of her tits curve out of the bold neck drop of this exact sports bra, and she wants to lick into the valley where skin meets fabric. But Adora drags the bra over her head as well, and Catra would not miss the sight to save her life when she comes face to chest with her destiny.

Adora's blush spills all the way down to her belly button. Everything about her is pink and pale, a sharp contrast to Catra's sun-kissed skin and dark body hair. She wraps her arms around Catra's torso and pulls her to her lips, kissing her absolutely silly.

She is braver now, maybe even needier. Catra doesn't know what has gotten into Adora to kiss her with so much fervor and want; short, rough licks and heavy breaths panting between wet drags of lips. Catra is falling behind, and her brain short-circuits at how her naked chest slides against Adora's; so she moans wantonly at Adora's tongue caressing hers, and just lets her kiss her however the fuck she wants. This is about her, after all.

Except — Adora freezes.

Her arms wrap even tighter around Catra – squeezing the life out of her – and before Catra can do as much as squeak, she finds their positions switched.

Catra's back hits the mattress, bouncing slightly. Adora's hand is high on her thigh, her silky hair in Catra's face. Their chests are

touching again, and Catra is fully content in her own personal heaven for a second before she remembers what they are supposed to be doing.

“Hey,” she says, praying to the gods that her voice is not as lustful and charmed as she feels. (Of course it is. But she managed to give it a playful edge, too.) “Having a hard time bottoming?”

From her grin, Catra knows Adora is a little embarrassed. She licks Catra’s chapstick off her lips. “No, it’s just…”

She keeps quiet for a long moment, trying to find the right words. Catra smooths Adora's hair behind her ear and cups her face, tilting her jaw so Adora would look at her.

As soon as their eyes meet, Adora finds her tongue.

“The sounds you make… they, um. They help.”

Catra drops her hand like Adora has burned her. She blinks rapidly, feeling the heat rushing from her core to her face. “Oh.”

“Yeah,” Adora says, giving her that breathless grin again. When she is met with a completely frozen Catra who is also beet-fucking-red, her features become steady. She asks Catra like she actually has a choice: “Can I touch you, too?”

Catra feels like the rug has been pulled out from under her. This is not what they agreed on; that was an offer of a helping hand. What Adora is asking for now is sex.

Can Catra’s heart even survive that?

There is a line somewhere – a line Catra should not cross if she doesn’t want to get hurt (she is already hurt) – but she is having a difficult time finding it. If she lets Adora touch her, too, she could have everything she’s ever wanted (lie). What's the harm in that? She could fuck the roommate she’s had the hots for (been in love with) for a year, and cross that of the list. Maybe she would finally calm the fuck down if she could get it out of her system.

If this is going to kill her, at least she'll die doing what she loves: Adora.

"Just for a little bit, okay?" Catra says, dropping her hands on the pillows. "Then we're back to focusing on you."

Adora's face pinches in pain. "If this is weird—"

"It's not," Catra cuts in, and braces herself for discomfort. She has to be (the right amount of) honest with Adora, and it makes her skin crawl. "But I'm the one who's supposed to make you feel good."

What Catra doesn't say is that Adora is a kind, generous person; that she is used to being used and never questions it. Catra has seen her hunched over the dining table at 4 AM on a Tuesday morning because she helped her friend finish a project for some college class. She has seen Adora pull an all-nighter to help out a colleague who said no to a task, knowing damn well that Adora would do it instead of them. Adora has come home late because she was grocery shopping for relatives, running errands for their neighbors, organizing every single team building event for work, birthday parties for her friends, vacations for her family. Adora said yes to everything, took it on herself to help everyone all the time, did everything she possibly could for the people around her whether she even liked them or not, whether they were just using her for her kindness or actually needed help, because it was "the right thing to do".

The first couple of weeks of living together gave Catra a constant headache. By the time Catra fell through the door, dead on her feet after work, Adora would have done her laundry, washed the dishes she left in the sink, and used her own groceries to make Catra dinner. It was the kindest thing anyone had ever done for her, so naturally, Catra started yelling.

Sure, she hates others doing her chores for her, as if she were not fully capable of doing so. That was part of it, too; feeling incompetent, babied, patronized. But when she screamed *You*

need to respect my boundaries and not touch my fucking stuff without my permission, what she meant is *Stop taking care of me. I don't deserve it, and I'm terrified of falling in love with you*.

So now, being splayed out below Adora, with the weight of her own feelings on her chest, Catra can't just take what Adora is so willing to give her. She isn't sure whether or not Adora has ever had people around her who prioritized her wants over their own, but she is determined to show Adora what it means to be taken care of.

"Catra?"

Catra blinks awake. She doesn't know how long she'd been frozen in place, but judging by Adora's worried tone, it must have been a while.

"Sorry," Catra says, squeezing her eyes shut for a second. "I was just thinking."

She can hear Adora gulp.

"Are you sure you're okay with this? I really appreciate you trying to help, but if it makes you uncomfortable—"

Catra grabs Adora's face and pulls her to her lips.

She tries to pour everything she is not embarrassed to feel into their kiss. For a couple of moments Adora is still confused, her mouth almost limp against Catra's; but something seems to translate in her mind, because she kisses back just as sweetly as she is being kissed.

Between little pecks, Catra murmurs, sickeningly sweet: "You are such an idiot."

"I know," Adora responds, pressing her lips to the corner of Catra's mouth. "But can you spell it out for me?"

Catra’s scoff chokes into a gasp as Adora starts a trail of kisses across her cheek, like she wants to kiss every single freckle she finds there. Catra's arms fly up to wrap around Adora’s neck almost instinctively. How could she lose to Adora so easily?

“I want you to touch me.” Catra’s ears droop at her own admission. It helps that Adora is still pressing insistent kisses to her face, and not looking at her. “I really, really do. But not as much as I want to give you what *you* want. If I let you touch me, I’m worried that I’ll… lose focus.”

You know I'm a selfish bitch, Catra thinks. *But I want to be selfless for you. I don't deserve you, but maybe I can give you something you deserve.*

Adora hums, stroking up Catra’s thigh. “So what you’re saying is… you just want to give me what I want?”

Catra’s *yes* is almost a hiss when Adora’s nails dig into her hips and her lips reach her jawline. She can feel Adora’s shit-eating grin on her skin as she asks:

“What if touching you is what I want the most?”

Catra doesn’t want to laugh, but it doesn’t matter. Adora’s lips are so warm on her skin, her hair so soft as it brushes her face, and her muscles are shivering from keeping herself a respectful distance from Catra as she waits patiently for permission.

“You think you’re so smart, don’t you?” Catra asks then, bringing her hands down the middle of Adora’s chest. Adora raises her head, and Catra savors the opportunity to kiss her again. “Keep it above the belt, okay? Then, if you can still move after I’m done with you, I am all yours.”

“Deal,” Adora says, sealing it with another kiss. She smiles down at Catra then, head tilted adorably. Her voice is low, rumbling in her throat; it makes Catra’s thighs clench. "Is there anything you don't like? Where can I touch you?"

Catra pouts.

"I know it would be so much sexier if I just moaned 'anywhere', but I really hate having my ears kissed."

"Noted."

"You can touch them, just…" Catra lets her voice fade out. She knows how she wants to finish that sentence, but she wouldn't be caught dead saying it out loud.

Adora would.

"Be gentle?"

"No," Catra lies. She hates how anger seeps into her words. "I just hate how people breathe into my ears. You don't have to be gentle with me. Don't think I can't take it."

"I don't," Adora says softly, and it's stupid, but Catra believes her immediately. "You're the toughest person I've ever known."

Catra tightens her jaw and nods sharply. She hopes that the gesture will serve as a conversation closer so she doesn't have to show how grateful she is for Adora's response.

There is just one issue.

As soon as they have discussed everything and Adora gets her permission, something switches in her brain. The previous shy, careful Adora is gone, and in her place, there is this… fuck, who even is this?

Adora kisses her fiercely, pressing their bodies together and grabbing a handful of Catra's wild waves without pulling them. The weight of Adora's chest on hers leaves Catra breathless, her whole body tingling as if she has never been touched before.

Catra is all but aware of how Adora is touching her everywhere at once, completely wrapped up in her warmth. The hand that had

been resting on Catra's hips starts to crawl higher, stroking along the fuzzy skin on Catra's navel, blunt nails barely scratching.

Catra's muscles tense. She cannot stop the shiver that cracks through her spine like electricity.

Adora's lips pop off of hers to continue their journey down the column of her throat. She doesn't seem to miss any of the spots where she can taste Catra's heartbeat pounding under her skin.

Catra is being very brave about it. That is until Adora's kisses turn open-mouthed with a hint of teeth, and her fingers brush the underside of Catra's breast.

Adora chuckles into Catra's throat at the whimper that escapes her.

"Shut up," Catra barks. It comes out as an exhale, weak and choked.

"I mean I didn't– I didn't say anything."

Ugh, even her voice is smug. Why does being a cocky bastard suit her so much?

To regain some sort of control (and purely out of spite), Catra raises her knee trapped between Adora's legs. The barely-there brush between Adora's thighs pulls a squeaky little noise from her mouth, and she drops her head.

Despite her telling reaction, Adora composes herself quickly. Her hand cups around the weight of Catra's breast, kneading gently, her lips sinking down on Catra's neck. Catra rocks her hips again, hoping that would be a good enough excuse for the needy little whimpers Adora's mouth chases out of her throat with every kiss.

"Do you like biting?" Adora asks her then, just a little rushed. Her breath is hot on Catra's skin.

Catra doesn’t trust her voice, so she just hums and lolls her head back to offer Adora more room.

Adora just kisses her again where her neck meets her shoulder. Her voice is lower than Catra has ever heard, her touch on Catra’s chest growing rougher. “I need a yes or a no, Catra.”

Catra gasps at Adora’s fucking infuriating confidence, squirming underneath her. Adora’s lips latch onto her collarbone now, her tongue dipping into the valley above it. Her teeth graze the edge of the bone, not sinking into Catra’s skin just yet.

Catra shivers, and Adora draws back to look at her.

Adora’s pupils are blown out. Catra can’t even see the color of her eyes anymore, devoured completely by lust and something adorably playful. Straw-blonde locks stick to her flushed face since Catra took her hair tie. The angle of her thick brows is stern.

“Answer the question.”

Up until this point, Catra was actually about to do so. Sure, she felt a little breathless when Adora’s palm pinched her pebbled nipple, nails biting into her flesh, so she needed a little time. Sue her. With her collarbone between Adora’s teeth, she just forgot there was even a question hanging in the air.

But now, catching that little gleam of challenge in Adora’s eyes, she wants nothing more than to push back and make Adora work for it.

“What question?” Catra asks, tilting her head to the side innocently.

Adora doesn’t answer her. She furrows her brows even more, her eyes darkening until they are pitch black; but Catra sees the little twitch in the corner of her mouth.

Never breaking eye contact, Adora grabs Catra’s wrists and pins her to the mattress with one swift shove. Adora’s arms are

straight as she leans her whole weight on them to keep Catra down, and Catra would swear that Adora can feel her frantic pulse as she holds her. Her tail is whipping the mattress in almost the same rhythm.

Adora grinds down without warning or mercy. Her hips clash with Catra's, their force pushing her higher on the bed and crumpling she sheets underneath her back.

Catra is not proud of the sound she makes. Or the next one, when Adora does it again and stays there, keeping their cores tightly pressed together. Adora rocks into her gently now, inviting Catra to crash into her waves.

Between pants of unintelligible crap, Catra finds a couple of words she wants to growl at Adora. "You were supposed to— *ah* — keep it above the belt you fucking— *fuck*."

Adora laughs, loud and full of heart. Catra wants to record it and play it on repeat to fall asleep to. "Fucking fuck? Wow, where's your famous wit?"

"Oh, I don't know, where could it have gone? I wonder who decided on fucking trib–" Catra swallows her words when Adora rocks into her again, baring her teeth.

This time, Adora bends her back to reach Catra's lips and kisses her with a hunger Catra didn't know she understood. When they part, Catra's chest rises for air; she forgot breathing was an option.

If Adora keeps this up, Catra is actually going to die – and she can't blame anyone but herself.

"I have no idea what you mean," Adora muses, staying close to steal another kiss. She eases her grip on Catra's wrists to lace their fingers together and cocks an arrogant brow. Her whispers are tickling Catra's lips. "I'm only touching your hands, aren't I?"

"Bite me."

“Yeah, I know, I’m the fucking fuck.”

“No, I— I’m answering your stupid question. I’m asking you to bite me.”

“Oh!” Adora punctuates her surprise with another wave, laying her bare chest back on Catra’s. Her arms bend, coming to lay next to Catra’s as she keeps her pinned down. “Wow, so needy.”

“*You—mmh*.”

The first thing Catra feels is Adora’s tongue on her vein, calling for her blood. It’s so stupid, to blush so easily at the softest touches. Catra feels like she is melting under Adora’s heavy warmth, limbs trembling like jelly, and when Adora finally, finally sinks her teeth into her throat, she—

Adora whines around Catra’s skin, hips stuttering. She takes her mouth off Catra’s skin just to squeak “*Holy shit,*” and bites her again. And again. And again; each bite is harder and deeper than the one before.

It takes Catra a second to notice what has caused Adora to go absolutely feral on her neck, and when she does, she wants the mattress to swallow her whole.

She is purring. Straight up, full volume. It’s unstoppable, and the most embarrassing thing that has ever happened to her. She doesn’t fucking *purr* during sex. It just never happens. Her definition of “safe and relaxed” doesn't include having people around her. Or inside her, for that matter. Why is her body betraying her right now?

But *oh fuck* quickly dissolves into *eh, fuck it* when Adora presses her even harder into the mattress and lets go of her hands just so she can hold Catra better. One hand slides under the small of her back, so where Adora presses down, she can hoist Catra up to crush her into her chest. The base of Catra’s tail is trapped between Adora’s middle and ring finger, lashing as much as it can.

The other hand is stretched across Catra's scapulae, and cups the back of her neck to keep her steady.

She starts grinding into Catra again; a steady, slow pace that gradually increases with each move as lust starts to take over Adora's cloudy mind.

Catra moans loudly, her head thrown back and her eyes snapping to the ceiling. Now that she is free, she slams her hands on Adora's ridiculously muscular back, and holds on for dear life. She is burning, completely out of control with everything that is happening, but as long as Adora is enjoying herself, they are sticking to the plan.

Adora mumbles something Catra doesn't catch between the waves of her hips, her mouth finding Catra's collarbone again. This time, she bites down on it hard with sharp teeth and dedication, and Catra cries out. Her claws are plowing the flesh of Adora's back as she rocks her hips up, chasing Adora's and her release.

Completely out of gay, horny instinct, Catra rasps praises and encouragement between collisions, but she is too far gone to be coherent or even know what she is saying.

She is also too busy losing her shit over how her words make Adora squirm and whimper to realize that her tongue is coated with bitter disappointment. She is happy to help Adora come however she wants to get there, but she really, really hoped that she'd get to touch her.

She wanted to see her fully naked, splayed out beneath her. She wanted to dip her fingers into her warmth, feel Adora clench around them with a cavernous need only Catra can fill. She wanted those muscular thighs to almost crack her neck when Catra was going down on her, licking her into unconsciousness. She wanted to taste Adora's moans on her tongue and swallow them when she kissed down the front of her throat. She wanted to breathe kisses on the pink of her chest, the deep V of her core, the constellation of moles above her wiry curls. She wanted her

hand to go numb with the heavy buzzing of the bullet vibe in her hand, not to be forgotten in her pocket.

Adora's growl awakens her from her dreamy haze. She is frozen above Catra, hanging her head again and pushing herself up on her hands.

Catra's throat goes dry, her purrs dying out. "Did you—"

"No," Adora barks, raking her fingers across her forehead and into her hair. She leaves her palm on the crown of her head, clutching her roots, and sits back on her heels next to Catra. "It's— fuck. It's not going to happen. I'm so sorry."

When she sits up, too, Catra's heart drops back into her chest. She hates herself for the liquid relief that floods her veins.

Her giggles sound faint; hopefully calming, too. "Adora, you were grinding on me with like, four layers between us. It's really not your fault. Even if we were both stripped down to nothing, not everyone can come from just tribbing."

Adora nods sternly. Her lips are moving like she is actually drinking in Catra's words. She looks at her then, tipping her head to the side. "Can you?"

Catra opens her mouth. Closes it. Tries to breathe. Adora is looking down at her with nothing but innocent curiosity, like she didn't just ask Catra if she, personally, could cum from scissoring.

"Depends," Catra finally says, her voice a little strained like she could still feel Adora's weight on her.

"On… what?"

Fuck. Catra kind of assumed that this would also include *some* sort of sex ed; Adora seemed to be confident in her own knowledge of anatomy and her abilities to make shit up as she goes, learn her partner's body and reactions quickly, and play off them. Adora is a researcher type, but even if she did her

homework right, all she would find is “everybody is different” and “find out what makes *you* feel good” and “communicate”. It makes sense, Catra assumes, that she never really felt brave or comfortable enough to ask those girls why something worked for them. With the score being fuck-knows-how-many to zero orgasms in favor of Catra, Adora has never had the chance to figure anything out on her own, either.

“On… my mood, I guess. And my… partners. You know. Anatomy, too.”

Adora continues to comb through the length of her hair, weaving the locks between her fingers at the end. Her chest rises and falls with a deep breath, the gleam in her eyes sharpening when she asks: “How can someone make you come?”

It’s not fair. It’s a really, really low blow, honestly. But Adora is about to learn something about Catra: that nothing is too low for her.

“I can show you what I like," Catra says. "On you.”

Adora’s throat makes a soft noise. It is not a protest, so Catra turns on her knees and puts a warm hand on Adora’s shoulder to push her back. Adora’s ass slips off her heels, her legs opening for Catra to settle between them.

Adora’s hands come to rest on Catra’s waist. They are not pulling her in, nor shoving her away; just holding her safe and steady like they have found a spot they want to stay at forever.

Catra cups Adora’s cheeks, and tilts her jaw up so their eyes align.

“Do you still want to be touched?” she asks quietly.

Adora’s lower lip quivers, so she sucks it between her teeth. Her gaze flickers down before she meets Catra’s eyes again. Her voice sounds like a sulking – but very stubborn – child’s. “I don’t want to disappoint you.”

“Baby, you can’t,” Catra says before she can bite her tongue. A sharp inhale shoots into Adora’s lungs, thumbs digging into Catra’s stomach as her grip tightens. Catra does something she hasn’t really done since elementary school: starts stuttering in embarrassment. “Sorry. That… It just slipped out, I didn’t mean __”

She clamps her mouth shut when Adora smiles up at her, eyebrows pinched high up on her forehead. Adora is looking at her like… Catra doesn’t even want to say how. It’s stupid. And most likely wrong.

“What?” Catra tries to bark, but ends up mumbling.

“You can call me anything you want,” Adora says, like it is a confession, and shrugs to ease its weight. “I’ll like it all.”

Overwhelmed by her thoughts, Catra silences herself by pressing her lips to Adora’s.

Adora melts into it, not even trying to stifle a happy hum. She pecks Catra gently, pulling her in by her waist until their bodies are flush against each other again, and Catra can crawl into her lap without breaking the kiss.

“Well, except—” Adora mumbles with their lips still sticking together.

“Yeah?”

“Um. If it’s…” A kiss.” Actually, if it’s…” another one, ”humiliating. Or something. Can you ask first?”

Catra’s thumbs stroke along Adora’s cheekbones. “Do I look like I’m into that?”

“Not for you,” Adora says. “But maybe for your partners?”

Infuriatingly, Adora is kind of right. Catra hates herself enough on a daily basis: she absolutely doesn’t need anyone else repeating

all the degrading shit her mind is shooting at her at any given moment. She doesn't *like* using humiliating language for the people she fucks, but she's not opposed to it if that's what they want.

"Sometimes. Only if they ask for it," is what Catra says in the end. She leans her weight heavier against Adora until their foreheads touch. Her eyes fall shut, not ready to face whatever stupid look Adora is going to wear when she says: "I don't want to say anything that hurts you."

Instead of an answer, Catra gets another kiss. She is more than fine with that. It's searing and delicate, a little hesitant at first, so Catra can't help but squeak when all of a sudden, Adora falls back on the bed, dragging Catra with her.

Their foreheads knock into each other. It's almost echoing in the silence of the room.

Catra hisses, Adora *ow*s, separating their mouths.

"I'm sorry," Adora hurries to say, slapping a hand on the spot where they collided. "Fuck, I'm so sorry."

Catra just laughs, and tucks her aching forehead under Adora's chin. "It's okay! It's okay."

"Does it hurt?"

"Not more than yours," Catra says, lifting her head to grin up at Adora. "You have a very weird definition of giving head."

Adora snorts a laugh, throwing her head back in defeat. "I was trying to be smooth!"

"Oh, yeah? How's that working out for you?"

The corner of Adora's mouth curls into an impish smirk. Her hand strokes along Catra's spine before dropping down to grab onto her

ass. Catra's voice gets stuck in her throat, her hips grinding down involuntarily.

"You tell me," Adora says, her voice suddenly thick and a little breathless.

"Fuck you."

"Exactly," Adora's other hand sinks into Catra's hair, taking a handful of it at the nape of her neck. Pulling her in, she breathes onto her lips: "So get to it."

It is not that Catra has to swallow her retort. She doesn't even have one. Her mind is swept blank; even her *fuck you* was weak, and completely uncreative.

All she can come up with is: "You do have a hard time bottoming", to which Adora dares to fucking cross her arms under her head, and lay back onto the pillows like she doesn't have a care in the world. The pose opens her chest; Catra can't stop staring at her tits and the deep shadows her muscles have painted on her stretched arms. Adora cocks a brow and softens her smirk into an equally annoying smile that is trying to taunt Catra – and succeeds.

Catra shifts so her knees fall on either side of Adora's waist; one hand gripping the sheets by Adora's shoulder, the other resting on the middle of her chest. She kisses that irritating smile off her face, and rasps:

"Okay, pillow princess." When Adora's chest flutters under her palm, Catra nips at her bottom lip. "Let's see how much you can take."

A curse slips out between Adora's lips, and Catra feels delirious. Adora's heart is drumming feverishly under her palm, and Catra feels that beat between her own legs.

She starts kissing down Adora's jaw, her hand not hesitating to cup her breast and flick her thumb over her nipple. Adora

whimpers, her leg kicking out.

"Really?" Catra can't help but drawl into Adora's neck. "Fuck, you wouldn't last a second if I put my mouth on you."

Adora's breath is coming out in little pants. She is so responsive, and Catra can't figure out how she's never reached an orgasm before.

"Tell me what I can't do," Catra asks of Adora, smearing kisses down the front of her throat just like she had fantasized. "Tell me where I can't touch you."

Adora's cool and unaffected mask breaks right in front of Catra's eyes. She gives up her pose, hands coming up to the nape of Catra's neck and the small of her back, clutching her close. "I-I'm not sure," she stutters. "This is all new, so… do anything you want to me."

Catra's heart blooms. She peeks up at Adora's face from the space between her breasts, and finds her staring right at her. "Am I really the first one to touch you like this?"

Adora's nose is dusty pink. Her fingers twitch on Catra's neck, her confession just a whisper. "You are."

Catra cranes her neck to kiss her. She doesn't know how else to express what she wants Adora to know, and she really, really needs her to know.

When they finally part, Catra finds it difficult to open her eyes and meet Adora's hazy gaze, but she has to say this. "Let me know if I ever do anything that doesn't feel good. Okay?"

"Yeah," Adora sighs, pressing their lips together briefly. "I will."

"Okay."

Catra can't help stealing another kiss. Adora's lips are so pink and soft like rose petals, taste sweeter than honey, and Catra fell

victim to them hard and fast. She can't imagine what her life is going to be like when this is inevitably over and all that she'll have is the memory of them against her skin.

Catra separates herself from Adora's mouth begrudgingly, but then she remembers that Adora's body is full of perfect spots for her lips and teeth and tongue. Why stop at her lips when she can be the first one to claim every single inch of her skin?

Catra quickly sinks back to Adora's chest. She puts her parted lips to the bottom of her breast, tracing them along the curve. She gives Adora a hint of tongue then, teasing her nipple. Catra swears it hardens right under her tongue, and Adora chokes on a noise.

"I told you I'd show you what I like," Catra says, wrapping her mouth around Adora's nipple. She doesn't suck on it – not yet – just pulls it as gently as she can. "I really like my chest kissed. When someone does this…"

This time, she sinks her teeth into the flesh of Adora's breast. She still keeps it sweet and soft, so it won't sting much. Her tongue is flat against Adora's nipple now, circling slowly, and Catra starts sucking.

" *Fuck* ," Adora whines above her, tightening her grip on the nape of Catra's neck. It's almost painful, and Catra feels herself flowing into her underwear. "I should've… I should've done this to you."

Catra draws back with a lewd pop. She catches Adora's brows twitching at the sound.

"You like it?"

"God, yes," Adora breathes, almost laughing. "You feel amazing. Your mouth… fuck, your mouth."

"You can definitely fuck my mouth if you want."

Adora actually laughs, full-bellied now. It takes a couple of seconds of Catra not laughing along with her before she clicks her jaw shut and stares at Catra with wide, wide eyes. “Wait, you’re —”

“Serious.” Catra licks around the pink of Adora’s other breast, never breaking eye contact as she wraps her lips around it.

Adora’s other hand comes up to the back of Catra’s head, both clinging to her hair now. The moan that ripples from her chest is raspy and low, almost a grunt, and the sound rushes straight into Catra’s core.

Catra can’t hold back anymore. With Adora’s breast still in her mouth, she slips her free hand down between their bodies and Adora’s thighs.

Adora almost jackknifes off of the bed when Catra’s fingertips tentatively stroke her through her sweatpants. Catra presses calming kisses on Adora’s chest, keeping her down with her weight. She shushes her, bringing her hand to rest on the inside of Adora’s thigh to give her more time to adjust.

“Okay?” She asks.

“Okay,” Adora says without hesitation. “Just… surprised me.”

“I’ll go slow,” Catra promises, wrapping her free hand around one of Adora’s wrists. Adora’s hands are still buried in her curls, their grip burning deliciously. “If you don’t want to take anything else off, that’s fine too. I can touch you under them.”

Adora grimaces. “No, I— I want them off.”

“Brave girl,” Catra’s mouth says before her brain could catch up. At her words, Adora’s core jerks up towards Catra’s hand, almost rubbing herself against it. For a second, Catra feels so giddy that she is grateful that she’s laying down. She tries her goddamn best not to choke on her next words. “Can I take them off?”

“You too?” Adora asks, her voice trembling around the words hopefully.

"Sure."

Catra rises to her knees. She slides a little back on the bed, her hands stroking down Adora’s sides before they get caught on the waistband of her sweatpants. She meets Adora's eyes for a final permission, and Adora grants it to her with a little nod. Catra starts pulling. "Raise your hips for me?"

Adora’s ass lifts off the bed so Catra can pull the sweatpants over them. She peels them off slowly; for every inch exposed, she breathes a little kiss onto Adora’s skin. Goosebumps flare up under her lips, spreading down the length of Adora's legs.

By the time she nips gently at the skin stretched taut right above her ankle, Adora is plopping back down and laying there like a pile of mush.

Catra is watching with her chest full. This is Catra's greatest accomplishment in her whole wretched life. At least until she can help Adora reach her orgasm for the first time. But this will do – for now.

Catra’s eyes are raking over Adora’s body, appreciating every little detail they can latch onto. Adora’s hair is so fair it’s actually lighter than her skin, the curves of her muscles ethereal. She has way more moles than Catra had previously thought; they pepper her skin so high on her thighs that Catra would never have had the chance to see them if she didn’t strip Adora down to her boxers.

Jesus fuck, those boxers.

Catra snickers through her nose. “Superman boxers? Seriously?”

“Supergirl,” Adora corrects her, failing to feign offense.

Catra rolls her eyes, grinning. “So you actually *hoped* to get lucky tonight?”

Adora's face falls in surprise, then lights up like Catra had just given her everything she's ever wanted. "Was that a—"

"Okay, shut up."

"Oh my God, you are *such* a nerd."

Catra's whole face flares up. Why the fuck did she even say anything? She could be using her mouth for something way more useful.

Instead of responding to Adora and trying to save her honor, she leans in for a kiss and places a gentle hand between Adora's legs, cupping her through those idiotic boxers. The air is stuck in Adora's lungs, leaking out into the kiss as little whimpers when Catra starts to move her fingers experimentally.

Her other hand starts to push her leggings off her hips. She had almost forgotten the bullet vibe that stumbles out of her pocket once it is upside down. She breaks the kiss reluctantly to get off of the bed for a second, and uses both hands to shimmy out of her leggings. Her underwear is bikini cut and pitch black, which, *thank fuck* ; Catra feels exactly how drenched it is, but at least the fabric won't show it.

She crawls back onto the bed, in between Adora's legs where she belongs. Adora spreads her thighs wider for her, hips twitching nervously.

Catra picks up the forgotten bullet vibe. Adora's eyes are glued to it, her blush darkening. Catra pushes the button of the vibe. The gentle buzzing rushes through her arm, and the sound makes Adora shiver underneath her.

Catra hooks an arm under Adora's knee, lifting it up so she can press a kiss to the inside of her thigh. Just like she hoped, Adora's mind seems to ease with a deep sigh.

"What do you want, Adora?" Catra asks with her lips still sticking to Adora's skin. "I can use my fingers on you, however you want.

I can give you my mouth. Or, you can show me how you used my vibe, and I can help you.”

Adora's leg twitches against Catra’s cheek, and her eyes flutter to the vibe again. "I…"

Catra encourages her with another kiss. “There is nothing you could ask of me that I wouldn’t do for you. Okay?”

Adora’s voice breaks around Catra’s name. She sits up to cup the back of Catra’s neck and pulls her into a never ending kiss. “I want them all,” she confesses between their mouths so quietly that even Catra has a difficult time hearing her. “I want everything.”

Catra’s smile breaks their kiss. She pecks Adora on the lips one last time before she pushes her back, face hovering above Adora’s. “Everything, huh?”

“I know it’s too much,” Adora quickly says, shoulders rising to her ears. “I’m fine with anything, I promise. You don’t have to do anything you don’t want.”

Catra tilts her head and narrows her eyes at her. “You’re insufferable, you know that?”

Adora gasps, offended. “What?!”

“Insufferable,” Catra repeats for emphasis. She pokes Adora’s forehead with her index finger, leaving it there. Adora’s squint is cross-eyed as she tries to see what the fuck Catra is doing. “Let yourself want things, dummy. Stop acting like it’s your greatest shame to ask for a good fingering from your hot roommate. She already wants to fuck you.”

Adora rolls her eyes, but her lips curl into a grin. Catra can see on her face that this war against herself is far from over, but her muscles seem to ease once more – for now, at least. And that has to be enough.

“Okay, fine,” Adora says, lifting her head just to drop it back down onto the pillow. “I know it’s stupid.”

“I never said it was.”

Catra’s words have an edge so sharp she cut herself with it. Adora looks at her like Catra had slapped her, and Catra feels that sting in her throat.

“I’m not angry with you,” she says. She leans down to breathe a little kiss onto Adora’s lips, then to her cheek, down her throat. She strokes up Adora’s inner thigh with the toy, feeling Adora’s shivers melting into the vibrations. “I’m angry with everyone who made you feel this way.” Catra brings her lips down between Adora’s breasts, nipping at them on the way. “I’m angry with the world that convinced you that you’re selfish.” Adora’s chest is heaving at the head of the vibe reaching her slit, her hands grabbing onto Catra’s arm and the nape of her neck. Catra stops, drawing back, but Adora moans for her to continue. “I’m angry with the people who use you. Who take advantage of you.” Adora’s needy noises are almost drowning out Catra’s words, but she doesn’t mind. She keeps the vibe against Adora’s core, her kisses reaching Adora’s belly. Catra slides her forehead against the valley between muscles, and whispers: “With girls who don’t deserve you.”

Whether or not Adora is in a state in which she understands what Catra means, Catra feels relieved. She peeks up at Adora, but all she can see is the curve of her neck, the sharp line of her jaw and the tip of her nose. Adora has thrown her head back, her chest rising off the mattress.

“I want to see you,” Catra says, her voice tight. “All of you.”

Adora snaps her head down, staring down at Catra, and breathes “Yes.”

Catra claws into Adora’s stupid Supergirl boxers without hesitation. Adora reveals all of herself, fighting against the jerking

of her thighs that want to close and hide her from Catra’s eyes.

Catra is lost in the sight of Adora for so long that Adora calls her name carefully. Catra meets her eyes, dark blue and full of unfounded insecurities.

“You’re beautiful,” Catra whispers, afraid of scaring Adora off but needing her to know. She can’t help herself. Adora is perfect, and Catra loves her so much she wants to cry, and it hurts like hell, and this was a stupid fucking idea.

Adora looks at her like she knows how close Catra is to bursting into tears. Her gaze is shimmering just like Catra’s, and when she parts her lips, a deep sigh escapes before her words could.

“Touch me.”

Catra swallows. She finds the vibe she had thrown somewhere before she pulled Adora’s boxers down, and turns it off. She wants her own skin against Adora’s, not some silky plastic.

It's so stupid. The only thing that could stop her is Adora telling her to stop, but Adora is telling her to go on, and Catra wasn’t lying before: there is nothing Adora could ask of her that she wouldn't do.

So Catra rests her palm low on Adora’s belly as she kisses her deeply, her fingers skimming the top of her curls, barely moving down as she caresses them. She weaves her fingers between them, still keeping her touch above Adora’s skin.

It’s lazy, and reverent, and yet, Adora starts to tremble in her arms. It doesn't ease at the gentle drags of Catra's lips, only becoming more insistent. Keeping distance between them as she draws back, Catra meets Adora's glazed eyes.

"Are you okay?"

"Mm-hm," Adora squeaks, lashes fluttering. She drops her gaze to Catra’s hand on her mound. "Just… nervous."

"Relax," Catra cocks her head and grins. "It's just me."

"Yeah," Adora sighs as a hurt smile pulls at her lips. Her hand rises to slither under Catra's heavy waves and cup the back of her head. Her eyes clear up, cutting into Catra's with the strength of a dagger. "It's you."

Adora pulls Catra down and meets her lips halfway. Catra has no time to overthink Adora's expression as her eyes fall shut and her lips open up for the taking. When Catra's hand explores more courageously, Adora whimpers into her mouth.

Catra's fingertips dip between Adora's lips, sinking south. She doesn't have to say anything before Adora breaks their kiss and sputters apologetically: "I-I can't really get wet. Like… I can, barely, but it's really difficult, it's not you, I promise I am *so* fucking turned on by you, and I really, really want this, my body's just—"

"If you say 'broken', I am going to cut your vocal cords out and braid them into your hair like a ribbon."

Adora laughs through her nose, but her eyebrows are still in a worried knot. Catra's fingertips slip lower, dipping into *some* wetness; it can't even hold a candle to what is happening between Catra's legs, but Adora is not bone dry either.

Catra's tail wraps around Adora's ankle to soothe her nerves. It makes Adora smile, if nothing else.

"You're okay," Catra says, and cups Adora's jaw to swipe her thumb across the apple of her cheek. "Do you have lube?"

"Yeah, I should," Adora says, turning her head towards the nightstand.

Catra follows her gaze. "There?"

"Mm-hm."

Catra stretches to reach the knob on the little nightstand and finds the lube laying right on top of some notebooks, old keys, and batteries. She quickly coats her fingers with two pumps, and brings them back between Adora's thighs.

Adora gasps softly at each one of Catra's strokes. Her eyes fall shut, her tongue darting out to lick her lips. Without the fear of being caught, Catra can stare at her handsome face and memorize everything: the graceful line of her crooked nose; her lush, fair lashes that swipe her cheeks; her wide, bow-shaped lips that open like a blooming flower so moans can spill freely from them.

Catra spends ages stroking careful, aimless caresses between Adora's legs, basking in the soft noises Adora makes. She cranes her neck to press her lips to the corner of Adora's mouth.

Adora's arms wrap around her neck, pulling her closer and holding her firmly in place – like Catra would ever think about leaving her side.

"You feel so good," Adora whispers, still afraid of saying her desire out loud.

"Yeah?" Catra asks, pecking Adora's cheek. "How about this?"

Adora's whimper is sharp as Catra brushes her clit. It sounds very much like a curse and hurts Catra's ear up close, making it flutter. Catra couldn't give less fucks even if she wanted to. She starts to swirl her fingers, wary of the pressure. She is usually rough with herself, gentler with her partners, but she wants to be even gentler with Adora; not just because it is her first time.

"Good?" She breathes onto Adora's flushed skin, nipping it.

"'s so good," Adora mewls. She sinks her hands into Catra's hair like she did before, tugging on her curls to ground herself somehow. "Can you—" She bites back her words before Catra could understand her.

“Anything. Tell me what you need.”

Instead of an answer, Adora gives her another pretty sound that she feels echoing in her skull.

Catra grits her teeth, trying to stay inside her own body and not become one with Adora’s. She notices too late that she has lost focus, only now realizing that she is touching Adora with more intent when she cries out, tightening her grip around Catra’s hair.

“That,” Adora breathes. “That, please.”

“Harder?”

“Yes. Yes.” Catra does as she’s told, and her reward is another beautiful sound Adora makes deep in her throat. “Fuck— *more* .”

Catra echoes Adora’s curse, laying her weight heavier on her. Her lips slip from Adora’s face to her neck, ducking her head under her chin and kissing her wherever she can reach. Picking up the pace seemed to work at first; Adora’s moan-tainted panting becomes a constant, rhythmic sound that burrows itself under Catra’s skin and nestles into her chest. She starts to move her hips, too, grinding up into Catra’s palm, but just as Catra’s muscles start to get sore, her wrist aching, Adora makes another sound that is familiar to Catra now: the same throaty, furious growl she heard right before Adora stopped them the first time.

Catra’s hand halts to a stop.

“No?” she asks, lifting her head.

“No,” Adora barks. She squeezes her eyes shut; every word she says grows louder than the one before, until Adora is almost yelling. “I don’t get it. You feel so fucking good. I’ve… I’ve never felt like this my entire life, how is it not enough?”

Catra tries to swallow the bile that poisons the back of her tongue. What, is she not enough for Adora now? That’s fucking rich.

She winces when she feels Adora's warm palm cupping her cheek, suddenly realizing what kind of face she must be making. She tries to relax her features when she meets Adora's eyes.

"It's not you," Adora says, caressing Catra behind her ear. Catra feels her ears droop, her scowl melting. "I just feel like I'm failing you."

Catra shuts her eyes. "God, I want to beat you up."

"I mean, you can try, but I'm much stronger than you," Adora says.

Catra ignores how wrong she is, and wraps her fingers around Adora's wrist.

"I can keep going all night, if that's what you want." Catra has always wanted to fuck Adora until sunrise, then sunset, only leaving her bed for food and the bathroom, but it seems like a really bad idea to mention that. "But I also don't want to make you feel even more frustrated with this, so… just let me know when you want to stop."

Adora takes a deep breath, and keeps it in her lungs. "Okay."

"So… do you? Want to stop?" Catra's voice is so weak it is almost unrecognizable.

Adora smiles and keeps stroking the base of Catra's ears. It's so soft, and a ridiculous turn-on. "No," she says quietly, raising her jaw. "I don't want to stop."

"Good," Catra grins, leaning forward to press a tiny kiss to the tip of Adora's nose. "Turn around."

"Huh?"

"I want to try something."

Adora obeys; she lays down on her stomach, showing Catra what she has been missing all this time. Her back looks like a raised-relief map of a mountain range, all gorgeous hills and valleys, myriad of spots Catra wants to explore with her lips and fingertips.

So she does.

Adora shivers at the first pressure of Catra's hand on her scapula, her lips on the arch of her spine. With every drag of skin against skin and admiring kisses, Adora starts to ease up. Catra follows the lines down, down, reaching the hollow above her ass.

Adora's nails claw into the pillow.

"Catra," she calls, voice breaking.

Catra's hand slides across Adora's gorgeous, plump ass, reaching below. "Raise your hips?"

Adora lifts her lower half, planting herself securely on her knees. Catra's fingers slip along her slit way easier now, and Adora rocks her hips back, chasing the heel of Catra's hand.

Adora almost jumps as she tears herself away, turning to plunk down on the bed and face Catra.

"No, no, no," she says, emphasizing every word in a different tone. Her face is in flames, her mouth twisting into a grimace. "That… no. It's just— not now. I just can't."

Catra shushes her gently, reaching out to squeeze Adora's shoulder. "Okay."

"It's just… a lot."

"Yeah."

It's a vulnerable pose, Catra knows. Now that she has gained her last brain cell back before inevitably losing it again, she knows she

wouldn’t have submitted herself like that to anyone for the first time either.

She does not plan on admitting that, and says instead: “I just wanted to see your ass.”

Making Adora laugh during her most embarrassing moments is everything Catra has ever wanted. She loves the way it makes Adora’s nose crinkle and brushes smile wrinkles to the corners of her eyes and mouth. She raises her fist in front of her lips, her blush seems to be permanent at this point, her eyes sparkling when she looks at Catra.

Catra never wants her to look away.

She expects Adora to ask her for the next step, or even start apologizing again for not being able to come. Instead, she wraps Catra in a warm embrace, and pulls her back on top of her. Catra can’t stifle a surprised, but delighted moan that escapes her throat as she kisses Adora back, weaving her fingers into Adora’s silky hair that has spilled all over the pillow.

There goes her brain cell.

Adora moans as if it is a response to Catra’s, hands roaming unapologetically all over Catra’s body. Every path of her palm burns into Catra’s skin, her tongue melting in her mouth.

Catra never wants to stop kissing Adora, but Adora has other plans, too. Catra barely grasps what is happening when Adora’s gentle hand cups her through her underwear like she has already forgotten what the rules were, her breath ghosting over her lips.

“Can I?”

Catra should say no. Remind her what they agreed on. This is not about her. This cannot be about her. She doesn’t deserve her. She is going to die.

“Please.”

Adora captures her lips again as her hand slips under the waistband of Catra's underwear, and Catra is losing her fucking mind.

Adora, honest to god, growls as she reaches Catra's warmth. Catra's face bursts into flames. She knows exactly what Adora is so amused by; it is almost hilarious how ready she is, turned on by just the way Adora *is* .

There is nothing tentative about the way Adora touches her. She moves her fingers with fervor, stroking Catra up and down.

Catra's hips start to rock without her permission, but Adora doesn't seem to mind. She is looking up at Catra with big, bright eyes, her lips popping open in amused delight.

"You're so gorgeous," Adora all but mutters, touching Catra even messier. It makes Catra's every single exhale a needy whimper. "Does this feel good?"

"What the fuck do you think?" Catra snaps, grinding down into Adora's hand like her life depends on it. She bumps her forehead into Adora's sternum, her knees trembling to keep her up. "Do I look like I'm having a horrible time?"

Adora giggles into Catra's hair, nuzzling and pressing kisses into it. Her free hand comes up to stoke the crown of her head so patiently, so languidly, like her other hand is not fucking the life out of Catra.

"You're amazing," Adora starts mumbling again, strained voice muffled by Catra's waves. "Fuck, you're amazing. So beautiful. So smart. I can't believe you let me touch you like this. You have no idea how much I wanted this. How much I wanted to have you. Make you mine."

Catra's body jerks frantically as her orgasm crashes through her like a wave. She gasps for air, eyes widening in shock; she's never had an orgasm like this, with no actual buildup, no warning, just

overwhelming, breathtaking, violent lightning that she feels in every fiber of her body.

Adora is almost whining louder than Catra is. Her hand has slowed down, but doesn't stop, luring out every aftershock Catra's worn out body is able to produce. Instead of gentle strokes, she uses Catra's hair as a handlebar again, and it almost topples Catra over the edge for the second time.

When Adora's hand stills, so does everything else. Catra is lying there on Adora's heaving chest, gasping for air. Adora's hand slides out from Catra's underwear and comes to rest on the small of her back, stroking soothing circles into her skin. Her other hand eases its grip, and massages Catra's scalp.

Catra blinks slowly, exhaustion taking over her. She won't give up without a fight, though. She raises her head, bumping into Adora's chin on the way.

When their eyes meet, Catra knows that there is no turning back. No one has ever looked at Catra the way Adora is looking at her, and now that it is a well-known fact that Catra is a fucking self-sabotaging idiot who has a death wish, there is no way she is getting out of this bed without tasting Adora.

Catra doesn't know how, but in nothing but a heartbeat, she is settled between Adora's thighs, lips just a breath away from her curls. Adora's smell is intoxicating; a mix of arousal and sweat and the unmistakable scent of her skin that Catra has been attracted to ever since Adora shook her hand when she introduced herself.

Catra peeks up at Adora for approval. She doesn't receive it in a nod or in words; instead, Adora raises her thighs and props them up on Catra's shoulders. She crosses her ankles behind Catra's back and presses the heels of her feet to the nape of Catra's neck without pressure: not to push, just to keep her there.

It is almost like Adora is avoiding speaking, too. Catra knows why *she* is not talking; with so much electricity in the air, cracking

through her veins, she might just say something incredibly stupid. If she spoke now, she would ruin everything with her feelings that are overflowing from the brim of her heart.

Instead of saying them out loud, she can show them.

She starts to pepper the crease between Adora’s thigh and mound with fluttering kisses. Adora moans pleadingly, shifting her hips so that Catra’s lips land on hers.

Catra bites her tongue, swallowing the words that would mean too much. She lets her breath warm up Adora’s core, and smears a closed-mouth kiss into Adora’s slit.

Adora whines again, writhing underneath her. Her thrashing pushes her heat into Catra’s mouth, her clit brushing her lips. It earns Catra an ever sweeter sound, so needy and desperate that she barely recognises it as Adora's.

For a couple more kisses, Catra is only using her lips to ease Adora into the sensation. She has to grab Adora’s hips and keep her still with all of her strength, but Catra doesn’t mind. Adora enjoying herself is all she cares about.

Adora actually gets wetter with every little peck; Catra can taste it on her lips when she licks them, opening up to take more of Adora. At the first hint of pressure of Catra’s tongue, Adora makes a deep, guttural noise that Catra can’t help but echo.

Blindly, Catra flings her arm onto the bed; she remembers the general direction of where she threw the bullet vibe. When her fingers brush against it, she gets a confident hold of it and turns it on. Instead of teasing Adora between her thighs again, Catra brings it up to Adora’s chest. She flicks the head of the vibe over Adora’s nipple just when her tongue presses deeper between her folds, and the reaction Adora grants her is electrifying. Purring blooms from Catra's chest again, vibrating on her tongue and taking Adora closer and closer to the edge.

Catra knows she is being merciless when she starts licking deeper, building towards an almost unbearable amount of pressure, but she can't help herself. She has to taste Adora with all of the ravenous hunger she has felt for so many months in secret. She doesn't know if Adora understands. She doesn't have to. All Catra wants is to drown in her love for this girl, whatever that might mean for her in the future. Catra doesn't think that far ahead. Tomorrow doesn't exist as long as her mouth stays between Adora's trembling thighs.

Adora sounds like she is sobbing above her. Catra peeks up from time to time to check if she has to control herself. Lust has stripped Adora from the softness in her voice, the baby blue of her eyes. Whenever she meets Catra's eyes, she bites down on her lip, her eyes narrowing in pleasure, her cries molding into helpless giggles.

Catra's lips curl into a mischievous grin, her tongue darting out to barely brush against Adora's clit. At this point, Adora is thrashing so forcefully under her that it knocks the air out of Catra's lungs; she is unable to keep her down anymore. Adora's legs are shaking around her neck, closing around her head and ears so hard that everything is becoming silent around her; a murmuring in the distance as if she were underwater. Adora's hips are rocking up, almost fucking her face. Catra's loud moan is muffled when Adora's hands find their way into Catra's hair once more, gathering her waves on top of her head before Adora's fists curl around them. The familiar burning is pushing her towards her own edge, depriving her of control.

Catra focuses her little licks on Adora's clit, closing her lips around it and sucking gently between flicks of her tongue. She barely picks up the pace, and her jaw hardly aches when Adora cries out, her throat raw; her legs collapse from Catra's head, and her hands cup Catra's face roughly.

"Come up here," Adora croaks, pulling Catra away from her core. "Come here."

Catra makes a tiny noise of protest, but then she is being kissed sweet and desperate, Adora's tongue rolling against hers, and she can't find it in herself to be angry.

Adora's lips pop off hers, then they meet again briefly. Adora stays close, her breath hot on Catra's face, her crooked nose brushing against the tip of Catra's own.

"I-I think I was close." Adora is out of breath. Her grip on Catra's face eases into gentle caresses with just her fingertips. "Maybe. I've never felt like that before, it just… it felt too much? Everything was so intense. I… I don't think I can take more."

Catra nods, her forehead knocking into Adora's. She stays there. "That's fair."

Catra shouldn't be surprised. She has been fucking Adora for hours now, of course the poor woman is sensitive. She had gotten so lost in Adora's smell and taste that she didn't even stop to think about the fact that she'd been edging her all night with no release. Sure, the no release part was not her fault (or anyone's), but Catra still feels responsible. Adora doesn't know her own boundaries, so Catra should have paid more attention to her body's reactions; not become unhinged at the first taste of Adora like a shark smelling blood in the water.

Adora sighs heavily against her, her shoulders slumping. She wraps her arms around Catra's back, and cocks her head to put her lips on her neck.

Catra nuzzles Adora's face. Her tail is stroking up and down Adora's thigh, then wraps around it. She turns off her bullet vibe and throws it somewhere on the bed for good this time.

Catra tries to ignore how her heart is sinking. So this is it. She got everything she wanted, right? Now she knows. She knows how sweet and soft Adora is between her thighs. She knows how maddening her moans are, how feral her growls can get when Catra pushes her buttons right. How she gasps for air at Catra's

tenderness, how she blooms pink from it like a rose basking in sunlight. She knows how silky her skin is to the touch, how warm she gets, how hard her muscles tighten under Catra's tongue. How her goosebumps taste. How her hair feels on her face. How desperately she touches Catra like her life depends on Catra coming on her fingers. How she captures her lips like Catra is a gasp of fresh air, and Adora is drowning.

And Catra will never feel like this again.

Adora's sighed curse awakens Catra from her haze. Her ears perk up and she tries to draw back to look at Adora, but Adora's hold tightens on her to keep her close.

"I really thought it was gonna happen with you," Adora says, stroking the nape of Catra's neck absentmindedly. "If I can't do it with you, how could I ever do it?"

Catra huffs. "What? Why me?"

"You know why."

Catra frowns. "What are you talking about?"

She can feel Adora swallow. Adora speaks a little slower now, confusion pouring into her voice.

"This is why you offered, right? Because you knew."

"Knew *what*?"

"That I…" Adora's whole body freezes. Her hands grab Catra's shoulders, squeezing so hard it hurts, and push Catra away from her so she can meet her eyes. Catra is basically forced into the cobra pose, except her arms curl to her chest like a T-Rex's. "You didn't. Oh my god, you didn't."

Adora releases her with another push. Catra falls down onto the bed, legs in the air.

Adora ignores Catra's cursing protests and springs to her feet. She is looking around frantically, jumping into her boxers and quickly pulling them up her legs. She puts her tank top on next, her head getting stuck until Adora growls and yanks the fabric down on her stomach.

Catra tires her goddamn best to calm her voice when she calls her name.

Adora shakes her head wildly. "I–I have to leave."

"Adora, this is your room."

Adora actually dares to spin on her heel and try to escape, but Catra is faster. She pounces off the bed, landing right behind Adora, and grabs her arm to stop her.

"I just—"

"No," Catra cuts in, letting her fury stress the word now. It makes Adora wince as she hangs her head and balls her hands into fists. At least she lets herself be turned around, and doesn't shake Catra's hands off when she curls them around her wrists and tugs her hands to her chest. "Do you really think I'm just letting you leave like that? What, do you fucking regret everything we just did? I am not as easy to throw in the trash after fucking as you think."

Adora's head snaps up. Catra sees tears shimmering in her eyes, some of them gushing out when her gaze lands on Catra's twisted face.

"No, no," Adora's voice creaks, her hands trembling in Catra's grip. "Catra, I swear that's not it."

"So speak," Catra spits.

"Fuck," Adora sighs again, baring her teeth. Her eyelids are quivering, too, when she closes her eyes, sniffing before opening them again. Her gaze has hardened, the shine in them sharp. "I

didn’t mean to use you, I promise. I’m so sorry, Catra." She sighs deeply, hesitating for a second before continuing. "I thought you offered your help because you knew I have… feelings for you.”

“What feelings?”

“Catra—”

“What. Feelings?”

Adora’s throat makes a strangled little noise.

Catra eases her grip, guilt and hope coating her tongue in a nauseating mix. Her head feels empty, like she is going to faint. Her thumbs are stroking Adora’s fists, lifting them higher until they are tucked under Catra’s chin so Adora can’t feel how furiously her heart is hammering.

Adora’s eyes latch on to their hands, then to Catra’s face, roaming all over her features before settling on her eyes. Whatever she found there, it gives her the courage to finally say:

“Catra, I love you.”

Catra rises to her tiptoes and presses her lips against Adora’s.

A tiny moan slips from Adora’s mouth, surprised at first. Catra releases her wrists to clasp her hands around Adora’s waist, pulling her flush against her. Adora’s hands fly to Catra’s face, framing it softly as she tilts her head; a shy request. Catra answers with her tongue teasing the seam of Adora’s mouth, and Adora meets her there.

Catra breaks the kiss hours later (that's how long it feels anyway), not drawing back an inch from Adora’s face.

Adora chuckles uncertainly. “Does this mean you’re not angry with me?”

“No,” Catra whispers, kissing Adora briefly again. Adora’s eyes are magnetic up close, pulling Catra in. “It means that I love you, too.”

Adora’s blush spills all the way down to her chest. Her little hums are delighted, and just a touch delirious. “Really?”

“Yeah, dummy.” Catra raises a hand to swipe gently at the drying tears on Adora’s face. Her smile melts a bit, her tone gaining depth. “Really.”

Adora’s eyes darken, her features becoming reverent, and Catra can be certain that she understands. She breathes a kiss to Catra’s freckles, leaving her lips on her cheek, and Catra’s chest gets warmer, her guts mushier with every second. At this rate, she is going to turn into pumpkin soup at midnight.

“Also, what the fuck did you think I was doing?” Catra asks, her voice a little squeaky. “Did you seriously think that I knew you were in love with me and I was like ‘hey, let’s fuck this girl and break her heart’?”

“*No*. It sounded more like a noble offer,” Adora mumbles into Catra’s skin. “Y’know, you saw me needing help, so despite you not feeling the same, you decided to give me what I want. I was mostly relieved you weren’t disgusted by me. Or by touching me.”

“I don’t know, handsome, it still sounds like a pretty shitty thing to do,” Catra says, raising her jaw to melt even more into Adora’s lips. “But I guess what I actually did wasn’t better, either, so. I am the one who used you."

Adora drops her hands to sneak around Catra’s waist, squeezing her tight.

"No,” she says stubbornly. “That logic only applies to me. You can use me however you want."

Catra raises her eyebrows, a smirk pulling at her lips. Even though Adora can’t see her, somehow she knows exactly what kind of

face Catra is making.

She drops her forehead to Catra's shoulder. "...I just heard that."

Catra laughs, feeling like her chest is going to burst. She is holding the girl she loves, the girl who loves her back, and it feels so right; it feels like something finally makes sense.

"Um," Adora says, not moving from her hiding place. "I meant what I said before. I'm probably done for tonight, but… I'd really like to touch you again. If you want."

"Yeah?"

Adora raises her head, kissing Catra's jaw on her way. Her smile is coy when she looks at Catra.

"Yeah. I can't stop thinking about going down on you."

Desire stabs Catra in her core, twisting a blade of fire. Just imagining Adora's head between her legs is enough to make her whole body tense, muscles only unchaining if she finds her release.

Catra claws into Adora's waist, pulling her in for a mellow kiss.

"Next time, okay?" she says in the end, pecking Adora between sentences. "As much as I'd love that, I don't want to be the only one being touched. I couldn't get enough of you either, so let's just wait. We have time now, right?"

Catra swears she could see the hearts in Adora's eyes, but then Adora ruins it.

"Not a pillow princess either, huh?"

Catra groans, feigning exasperation. She slaps her palm on Adora's cheek, mushing it to her lips. Adora snorts, laughing like nothing could ever be funnier than this, and Catra feels her walls of defense crumbling down.

They end up finishing their horrible movie, huddled close on the couch. Adora's strong arm is around Catra's shoulders, her lips tangled in her curls to press insistent kisses to the top of Catra's head. Catra rests her head on Adora's chest and her hand high on Adora's thigh, stroking mindless shapes onto her skin.

They order takeout. Catra feeds Adora lemon chicken, giggling as sauce drips down her chin. Adora swallows the bite, and asks: "Oh, you think it's funny?", before bending forward to kiss Catra deeply, smearing sauce all over Catra's chin and lips. Catra shrieks and tries to push Adora away, but unfortunately, it turns out she was right before – Adora is stronger than her.

They wash up, one after another in the narrow bathroom. When Adora comes out, smelling like sandalwood and seasalt, she finds Catra leaning against the doorframe of her room, ankles crossed and tail curling around her calves.

"Hi," Adora says. The affection in her voice is sickeningly sweet and heavy with longing.

Catra holds out her hand. Adora takes it. Catra pulls her into her room and close to her heart, and holds her like she is something precious and fragile. She touches her face, fingertips slipping over silk. She takes a deep breath, and tries to believe that this is her life now. This is real. She cranes her neck to kiss Adora, and her lips don't turn into pixie dust under hers. She weaves her hand into Adora's wet locks, and they don't turn into golden threads. Adora presses back, kissing her like her lungs would collapse if she doesn't drink Catra in.

Adora is here, and she is not going anywhere. She will be here tomorrow morning when Catra wakes up with Adora curled up in her arms, their legs tangled under the sheets. She will be here the day after tomorrow, welcoming Catra home with a kiss and Catra's favorite meal steaming on the stove. She will be here next week, next month, and if Catra is really, really lucky, she will be here next year, and all the years after that.

Catra will do everything in her power to keep her here, and love her like Adora deserves to be loved: with everything she has.

“Hey, Adora.”

End Notes

Hey hey hey, welcome to the ace lesbian agenda. :)
I *could* be persuaded to write another chapter about the first time Adora is able to come.

This story is so fucknig important to me, and if you are here, reading this, I owe you a thank you because you made me feel seen.
I could write so much more about this, but honestly I hope this fic speaks for me. It is a love letter to the people who are struggling to feel normal, and for the fandom I feel so much love for every single day.

Comments and kudos are very appreciated. x

Come hang out with me on Twitter, I'm usually nice. Or Tumblr, that is fine too.

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!